

GreenAddress: GreenAddress is a multi-signature open source wallet with a high level of security because of the use of special trusted ECDSA key pairs to transfer funds. GreenAddress offers desktop, online and mobile (Android and iOS) wallets. Private keys are never held by the third-party server side. Payments have to be approved by GreenAddress itself, which is an advantage in some ways as it provides the same restrictions as traditional banks on large transfers.

Features:

- Per-transaction 2FA via multi-signature, of four different kinds: email, SMS, robot call and Google Authenticator.
- 2-of-2 multi-sig accounts: Creates accounts that can take advantage of GreenAddress' trusted-third-party instant confirmations. Account recovery without access to GreenAddress is achieved with pre-generated nLockTime transactions.
- Transaction information within 2FA message.
- BIP0039 mnemonics for sending/receiving protected Bitcoins.
- Dynamic and comfortable fees for transactions.
- Prevention from malware, theft and firewalls with reliable encryption.
- Barcode usage for sending and receiving funds.

Pros: High-security with two-factor authentication, multi-platform, open source, multi-sig wallets, and API tools available.

Cons: Not good for beginners, setup takes a long time, and it only supports Bitcoin.

Official website: <https://greenaddress.it/en/>

MyEtherWallet: MyEtherWallet is an open source, JavaScript, client-side tool for generating Ethereum wallets and sending transactions. It was created by Kvhnuke and Tayvano. It provides a highly flexible user interface to access the Ethereum blockchain network and operates securely on the Ethereum network. It is a go-between that makes it easy for individuals to store Ether and other ERC-20 assets on the Ethereum platform. Although it is accessible through the Web, users' cryptocurrency wallets are stored directly on their computers, and not on the MyEtherWallet servers. MyEtherWallet is deemed a client-side interface that allows users to create wallets online before storing one's digital assets offline in a hardware wallet, eliminating the security vulnerabilities of housing Ethereum in a Web based wallet.

Features:

- Compatible with Ethereum, Ethereum Classic and other ERC-20 tokens.

- Open source with access via almost all operating systems.
- Doesn't charge any fees from users.

Pros: Free service, no storage of sensitive data on MyEtherWallet servers, supports offline cold transactions, and is clear and easy to understand.

Cons: Prone to phishing attacks, no hierarchical deterministic key generation, multi-signature and has two-factor authentication.

Official website: <https://www.myetherwallet.com/>

Electrum: Electrum is a lightweight Bitcoin wallet that navigates the thin line between a good user interface and functionality. It encrypts private keys locally, supports cold storage and provides multi-signature capabilities with minimal resource usage on machines.

Features:

- *Encrypted wallet:* This is a file that contains Bitcoin private keys and is protected with a password.
- *Deterministic key generation:* If you lose your wallet file, you can recover it from its seed.
- *Transactions are signed locally:* Private keys are not shared with the server.
- Many leading hardware wallets can interface with Electrum.

Pros: Firewall friendly, written in Python, support for third-party plugins and Bitcoin URIs, signed URIs and Bitcoin aliases, and no single point of failure.

Cons: Only supports Bitcoin, and is not suitable for beginners.

Official website: <https://electrum.org/#home> 

References

- [1] <https://brd.com/>
- [2] <https://github.com/bitpay/copay>
- [3] <https://jaxx.io/>
- [4] <https://www.bitcoinarmory.com/>
- [5] <https://greenaddress.it/en/>
- [6] <https://www.myetherwallet.com/>
- [7] <https://electrum.org/#home>

By: Anand Nayyar

The author works at Duy Tan University in Vietnam. He loves to explore open source technologies, sensor communications, network security and the Internet of Things. He can be reached at anandnayyar@duytan.edu.vn. YouTube channel: Gyaan with Anand Nayyar at www.youtube.com/anandnayyar.